

Eating Well with Pre-diabetes or High Blood Glucose

Eating for pre-diabetes is about steady habits, not extreme rules. The goal is to manage blood glucose by choosing better carbohydrates, sensible portions, and balanced meals across the day.

Build meals around fibre and balance

Choose wholegrains more often, such as brown rice, oats, wholemeal bread, or wholegrain noodles when available. Wholegrains and vegetables provide fibre, which helps you feel full and can support steadier blood glucose after meals.

Use the healthy plate pattern: half vegetables and fruit, one quarter wholegrains or staples, and one quarter protein foods. Protein foods such as fish, chicken, tofu, eggs, beans, or lean meat can help make a meal more filling. Pair carbohydrates with protein and vegetables instead of eating a large plain carbohydrate portion by itself.

Meal part	Better choice	Practical example
Staple	Wholegrain or smaller portion	Brown rice at economy rice
Vegetables	At least one generous serving	Add greens to noodles or soup
Protein	Include at each main meal	Fish soup with tofu or egg
Drink	Unsweetened or less sweet	Water, kopi kosong, teh siew dai

Spread carbohydrates across the day

Try regular meal timing. Large gaps can lead to overeating later, while very large carbohydrate portions can raise blood glucose more than expected. Spread rice, noodles, bread, fruit, and starchy foods across meals instead of saving most of them for one heavy meal.

Avoid skipping meals or crash diets. Very low-calorie diets need medical supervision. A steadier approach is easier to keep and safer for most adults.

Hawker examples

At economy rice, choose brown rice if available, two vegetable dishes, and one protein dish, with less gravy. At a yong tau foo stall, choose soup, add leafy vegetables, tofu, egg, or fish items, and go easy on fried items and sweet sauces. For chicken rice, keep the rice portion modest and add vegetables. For thosai or chapati, pair it with vegetables and a protein item.

Swap sugary drinks for water, unsweetened tea, kopi kosong, or siew dai options. If you drink sweet beverages every day, reduce step by step.

Watch portions without counting everything

Use your hand as a simple guide: a palm-sized protein portion, a fist-sized staple portion, and two handfuls of non-starchy vegetables. Adjust based on hunger, activity, and advice from your healthcare team.

Key points

- Choose wholegrains and high-fibre foods more often.
- Keep carbohydrate portions sensible and spread them through the day.
- Pair rice, noodles, bread, or fruit with protein and vegetables.
- Replace sugary drinks with unsweetened or less sweet options.
- Keep regular meal timing and avoid crash diets.

When to talk to a health professional

See a doctor if you have a high blood glucose result, symptoms such as unusual thirst or frequent urination, unplanned weight loss, pregnancy, or other health conditions. A doctor or dietitian can personalise your food plan and follow-up checks.

This guide is sample content written for the LiveWell Coach workshop. It is general information, not medical advice. If you have symptoms or a health condition, speak to a doctor.